

MARKETING SWEET · ROLEPLAY 01

The Three-Website Demo

Session tie-in: Session 01 — Pitch High, Show the Stack, Let the Customer Choose

Difficulty: Easy–Intermediate · **Run time:** ~15 min · **Reps required:** 2

The setup

You're sitting opposite **Brendan Marshall**. He owns *Solid Foundations Bricklaying*, 12 staff, 25 years in the trade, mostly commercial subcontracting and high-end residential. Estimated turnover ~\$3M. His current website is six years old, looks like a 2018 WordPress theme, and ranks for nothing.

You've been on site for 40 minutes. Affordability — checked. Intent — he said on the phone last week, "I think we need a new website but I just want a basic refresh, nothing fancy." You've spent the meeting building connection, mapping his business, and previewing what's possible. Now you're at the part where you talk price.

You are Marketing Sweet. Your job: pitch the highest tier first, let him work down, never ask "what's your budget."

Coaching note — before you start: Brendan saying "just a basic refresh" is *not* him telling you what he can afford. It's him bracing for sticker shock. Your job is to widen his frame, not match it.

THE SCRIPT

REP: Brendan, before I walk you through pricing, I want to show you three websites we've recently built — all for trade businesses around your size. I'll show you all three and you tell me which one feels most like the business you're trying to build.

[Rep opens laptop, three browser tabs already loaded.]

REP: *[Tab 1, full-width hero, premium feel]* This one's *Halverson Carpentry* — 18 staff, similar to you but slightly bigger. Custom homes, commercial fit-outs. They invested \$10,000 in this build. Got six extra landing pages — one for each service area. Real photography on site. We do their SEO too, page-one rankings for "luxury custom home builder Adelaide." Their leads have doubled since launch.

Coaching note: Pitch the top tier *first* and *with conviction*. No hedging language. Don't say "obviously this one's a bit much" — that's the death sentence. Anchor at \$10k. Everything below will now feel measured against it.

REP: *[Tab 2, similar style, fewer pages]* This second one's *Talbot Brick & Block*, similar size to your team. They went with the \$8,000 build. Same core layout as Halverson, but six

landing pages instead of twelve. Excellent results — they rank for their main service terms locally, leads coming through every week.

REP: *[Tab 3, simpler design but still clean]* And this third one is *Reid Bricklaying* — eight staff, just south of you. They went with our entry tier at \$7,000. Solid, clean, baseline. Generates referral traffic and looks professional. It's a real foundation to build from.

REP: *[Pause. Closes the laptop slightly so the screen isn't a barrier.]* Brendan — which one of those feels most like the business you're trying to build?

Coaching note: That question is the load-bearing line of the whole pitch. NEVER replace it with “what's your budget?” That question, in Corie's words, is offensive and lazy. The visual-preference question forces him to choose by outcome, not by sticker shock. His pick is his real spend tolerance — he's qualifying himself for you.

THE FORK — Brendan tries to deflect:

BRENDAN: Mate, just tell me what's cheapest. I don't need all the bells and whistles.

Coaching note: Don't fold here. If you say “right, \$7k it is,” you've trained him that price questions get instant discounts. Reframe and bring him back.

REP: Totally hear you. Same question, different angle — out of those three, which one looks closest to where you want *Solid Foundations* to be in twelve months? Not what's cheapest. What feels right.

BRENDAN: *[Pauses. Looks at the laptop again.]* Probably the Talbot one. It's clean. Not over the top.

Coaching note: That's the middle tier — \$8,000. He picked it visually. He didn't pick it on price. That's the entire point of the method.

REP: Talbot's a great pick. Same craftsmanship as Halverson's, just scaled to where you are now. Most clients your size go this route — six service-area pages, real on-site photography, full SEO setup. \$8,000.

BRENDAN: *[Eyebrows up]* That's a fair whack though.

Coaching note: This is the predictable price-flinch. Don't break eye contact. Don't apologise. Don't volunteer a discount. Pause and hold the number.

REP: *[Holds the pause. Two full seconds. Then:]* It is. And it's the build that gets you the lead flow Talbot now has. The Reid build's \$7k if you'd prefer to start at the entry tier — solid product, just less reach. Which makes more sense?

BRENDAN: *[Pauses again.]* Look — I could probably do the \$8 if it's structured monthly. Can we do anything on price?

Coaching note: He's negotiating. That's a buying signal, not an objection. Don't panic-drop. Hold the line and trade something for something.

REP: I'm not going to play games with you on the number, Brendan. The build is \$8,000. What I can do is monthly payments over three months — that's normal for builds your size. And here's the close: if you give me the green light today, I'll throw in the on-site photography day — that's a \$600 value normally — at no extra cost. You'd be saving the \$600 and getting a head start. Fair?

BRENDAN: Yeah, alright. Let's do it.

Coaching note: He didn't say "let me think about it." That's because you held the price, but gave him something to feel like he won. Photography session is small in your margin, big in his perceived value. That's the trade.

STRETCH VARIATIONS

Run the same script with these prospect twists and see how the rep handles them:

- **Brendan picks the \$7,000 tier.** Don't try to upsell him in the meeting. Win the deal at \$7k, close cleanly. Upsell happens organically at month six.
 - **Brendan picks the \$10,000 tier.** Don't celebrate. Stay rock solid, send him the link, ask about the kick-off call.
 - **Brendan says "I need to think about it."** Run the diagnostic from Session 01: is this price (most common, recoverable), trust (you said something off), or partner approval (genuine)? Apply the right tool from the session debrief.
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WHAT TO LOOK FOR WHEN YOU'RE PRACTISING THIS

- Does the rep pitch the top tier with full conviction, or do they soften their voice on it?
- Does the rep ask "which feels like the business you want to build?" — or does an "what's your budget" leak out?
- When Brendan pushes for "cheapest," does the rep fold or reframe?
- When Brendan flinches at the price, does the rep apologise or hold the pause?

Two reps swap roles every run. Spend 5 minutes after each run debriefing what worked and what didn't.